Syllabus: CIS-133JS Introduction to JavaScript

This is an online class. Here is a **link to this syllabus in PDF format**.

Instructor

Eric Artzt
Office hours: Mondays 8-9am or by appointment - Pioneer Hall
Contact: **eartzt2@cocc.edu**

Class Information

- **Course Title:** Introduction to JavaScript
- **Course Number and Class CRN:** CIS 133JS / 40301
- **Prerequisites:** CIS-122 (required), CIS-195 (recommended; or, existing confidence about HTML and the DOM)
- **Credits:** 4
- **Class Dates:** Fall 2026; 9/21/2026 - 12/11/2026
- **Class Meeting Times:** Asynchronous/online. Reach out to **Eric** to schedule 1:1 time.
- **Class Location:** **https://cocc.instructure.com/courses/27079**
- **Instructor:** Eric Artzt - **eartzt2@cocc.edu** - Office hours on Zoom, 10-11am Tue/Thu or by appointment

Course Description

Learn programming fundamentals and object-oriented concepts using vanilla JavaScript syntax. Add interactivity and custom behaviors to web applications by employing front-end JavaScript techniques combined with HTML and CSS.

Learning Outcomes

1. Implement scripts that rely on knowledge of Document Object Model (DOM) architecture and includes methods for manipulating DOM objects.
2. Construct functions that effectively utilize variables, conditionals, loops, and arrays.
3. Generate scripts that process user input and provide meaningful output.
4. Plan and create scripts utilizing events and event handlers that respond to user inputs.

Instructional Methods

I will post a weekly lecture(s) on our Canvas site here. These lectures will sit at the top of each module.

My hope is that in addition to listening to my lectures, and completing the assignments and quizzes, you will reach out to me if you would like to discuss any topic, or get help on your assignments or the class subject matter.

Communication and Timelines

Email is the preferred communication channel for any engagement that cannot be handled via pull request comments. Find me at **eartzt2@cocc.edu**.

I will answer emails within 24 hours.

I will review and grade assignments within three business days of submission.

Class Materials

- **Textbook Title:** *You Don't Know JS Yet* book series, 2nd Edition (*Get Started* and *Scope & Closures*)
- **Author:** Kyle Simpson
- **Cost:** Free to read online. Bound copies are optional.
- **License:** © 2019–2025 Kyle Simpson, **CC BY-NC-ND 4.0**
- **Online Link:** **https://github.com/getify/You-Dont-Know-JS**
- **Class assignment repository:** **https://github.com/artzte/cocc-js**

Technology

This class will be delivered through COCC's learning management system (LMS),**Canvas**. The policies and statements for the LMS are available online on the **COCC Technology Skills and Requirements** page.

Additionally, you will need the following in order to complete this course:

- A computer on which you can do web development. A Linux-based command shell environment is highly recommended; you can have this on OS/X or Ubuntu natively, or you can install the Windows Subsystem for Linux (WSL) on a Windows computer.
- A GitHub account with the ability to host private repositories. You can apply for a**GitHub for Education account at this GitHub link**; there are many benefits to academia-connected individuals for this account tier, so it is highly recommended. For information about digital accessibility at Github, please visit **their compliance page for Github Education**.
- A functioning NodeJS environment on your computer. My first week's materials will include a video on how to get moving.

Technology Assistance

- For Canvas assistance, contact 24/7 Canvas support by**live chat**, or Support Hotline: 1-833-209-6113
- For online class assistance, check out our**Self Help Resources page**
- For technology support (login, password reset, user name, etc.), visit our**Student Technical Support page**
- Technology lending, visit our **Library Technology Lending page**
- For individual assistance, visit one of the Computer Labs, email**techhelp@cocc.edu**, or call 541-383-7716.

Class Topics and Schedule

- **Week 1 — What Is JavaScript?** — JS engines, runtimes, strict mode, DevTools; dev environment setup; write your first test
- **Week 2 — Values, Types, and Variables** — Primitive types, strings, numbers, `let` / `const` / `var`, `typeof`; select and update DOM elements
- **Week 3 — Functions and Comparisons** — Function syntax forms, parameters, return values; strict vs. loose equality, truthy/falsy, conditionals
- **Week 4 — Arrays, Loops, and Iteration** — Array methods, `for` / `while` / `for...of`, higher-order methods (`map`, `filter`, `reduce`); *Project Milestone 1 (Proposal) due*
- **Week 5 — Lexical Scope** — How JS compiles before executing, lexical scope model, scope nesting, variable lookup
- **Week 6 — Scope Chain, Global Scope, and Variable Lifecycle** — Scope chain, shadowing, global scope in the browser, hoisting, Temporal Dead Zone
- **Week 7 — Closures** — Principle of Least Exposure, closure mechanics, factory functions, stateful encapsulation;*Project Milestone 2 (Design Document) due*
- **Week 8 — Classes and OOP** — ES6 `class` syntax, `this` binding, inheritance with `extends` / `super`, static members
- **Week 9 — Modules** — ES Modules (`import` / `export`), module scope, Vite and ESM, `localStorage` persistence; *Project Milestone 3 (Initial Structure) due*
- **Week 10 — Events and the DOM** — Event bubbling/capturing, `addEventListener`, event delegation, form events
- **Week 11 — Async JavaScript** — Event loop, Promises, `async` / `await`, `fetch`, error and loading state handling
- **Week 12 — Final Project** — Demo, code review, deployment; *Project Milestone 4 (Final Submission) due*

Due Dates for Major Graded Work

- Weekly quizzes and projects will be due on midnight the Monday following each week
- The final project is due in phases, on Monday at midnight following the referenced week
  - Week 4: Proposal
  - Week 7: Design document
  - Week 9: Initial structure
  - Week 12: Final submission

Final Exam Date and Time

We will just have the Final Project, which will be due during Finals Week.

Grading and Assignments

Grading Standard

I am committed to your success in this course. For your part, I encourage you to keep up with the weekly quizzes and

assignments, and communicate with me if you need assistance at any time. I will accept, and will not penalize, late work (up until exam week), but it has been my experience that students who get behind in these courses have great difficulty catching up.

- Weekly quizzes: 20%
- Weekly assignments: 40%
- Final project (divided into four equal deliverables): 40%

You may take one class week as a "bye week" during which you can skip your weekly assignment only. I will award full credit to you for this one-time "bye" on your weekly assignment. The final project assignments and quizzes, however, are all required.

Help on Assignments

I encourage you to use Github CoPilot to review your pull requests prior to submitting. Beyond that, you should not be getting help on your assignments from classmates or coding agents. Please reach out to me if you need help with your assignments.

Artificial Intelligence Policy

Students may not use GenAI tools in this course to produce course materials or assignments in whole or in part. All work you submit for this course toward completion of course requirements must be your own original work done specifically for this course and without substantive assistance from others, including GenAI. Work you've completed for previous courses or are developing for other courses this term also should not be submitted for this course.

There are two exceptions. First, as described under Help on Assignments, you may use GitHub Copilot to review your pull requests before submitting. Second, you may use GenAI tools to solve IT problems on your own computer, such as trouble with Git, Node and npm, nodenv, WSL, or other setup issues. You may not use GenAI to answer quiz questions or to build your assignments or final project.

Instructor use of AI. In the interest of transparency: this course's materials, including this syllabus, the course outline, reading summaries, lecture notes, assignments, quizzes, and code examples, were built in partnership with generative AI coding agents (Google's Antigravity CLI and Anthropic's Claude Code). The agents produced first drafts, which I then reviewed and edited. I am responsible for all of the content. My recorded lecture videos are entirely my own; I use the lecture notes and code examples only as rough outlines. The reason for the different rules is that the purpose of your assignments is for you to build skills by doing the work yourself. For details, see **"How AI Was Used to Build This Course"** in the course repository README.

Please see **Student Rights and Responsibilities** if you are unclear about COCC policies around academic honesty.

Grading Scale

See **COCC Institutional Syllabus**.

COCC Policies

See **COCC Institutional Syllabus**.